2016, as the army prepared to help raze Amona, a dozen soldiers left their posts and went to another outpost in a show of solidarity.

One case that became notorious was that of “David”, a soldier from the Nahal Brigade, who was filmed in 2014 threatening to shoot a Palestinian photographer. His behavior didn’t break any norms. Any journalist who works in the occupied territories, especially a Palestinian, has been caught up in similar situations. But it embarrassed the army because it was caught on camera. David was arrested. Hundreds of soldiers quickly posted photos of themselves holding signs that read, “I’m with David *HaNahalawi*” (a Hebrew word for a Nahal soldier). The photos, dubbed a “revolt” in the press, spread quickly across social media and websites like 0404, a popular right-wing portal. David was soon released.

A year later, when he passed his officer training course, the far-right activist Baruch Marzel wrote about him on Facebook. Marzel had once offered to buy pizzas for any soldier who killed a Palestinian attacker; he regularly invites the troops stationed in Hebron for Shabbat meals at his home, in an effort to spread his far-right views. (Azaria was one of his regular guests.) And he was, unsurprisingly, full of praise for David. “Good luck, hero,” he wrote. “We love you.”

Media and culture

Miri Regev enjoys being booed. An acrimonious populist and a rising star in the Likud party, she likes to cultivate an image as a sort of Daniel in the den of leftist lions. The gathering of artists at Tel Aviv’s museum in March 2016 was, to be sure, not the friendliest audience. Regev had been named culture minister almost a year earlier, and spent much of her early tenure butting heads with the cultural establishment, which she viewed as irredeemably liberal.

When she took the stage—at a conference organized by the liberal newspaper *Ha’aretz*—she wasted little time launching into a combative routine. “I was told to always start with a quote. It makes a cultured impression,” she began. “So here goes. As the famous Chinese philosopher Sun Tzu once said, ‘Cut the bullshit! Cut the bullshit!’”

Her quote, delivered in English, was quickly drowned out by boos. She plowed on, promising to expose the “hypocrisy” of Israeli artists. “We will guarantee loyalty to the laws of this country!”